

Five Steps to Financial Wellbeing

- Remind yourself, out loud if necessary, that the threat to your financial security and safety that you're imagining *isn't real*.
- Take some deep, relaxing breaths, or try repeating the self-trust meditation from Step One.
- If you're worrying about a purchase that you've already made, try distracting yourself with an activity that doesn't leave any room for anxious thoughts – something that gets you into a state of flow.
- Similarly, if you are sitting at home or in front of a screen dwelling on having spent money, try to get out of the house and into some green space.

The chances are that a lot of this misplaced anxiety around spending will be eased as you start to unpack your financial baggage, and come to terms with your relationship with money in the past, whether the factors leading to this anxiety are a product of your childhood or upbringing, or a product of decisions that you have made and rectified in the past – whether it is something that you inherited, or a case of 'once bitten, twice shy'. Hopefully, having worked through Step One, you will have started to process your past relationship with money and the factors influencing it, and now feel ready to implement some changes in the way that you think about and engage with money, which should, in turn, help to ease this anxiety and make you feel more confident in your decisions – so that you can enjoy the money that you earn.